

## TEMPLE TEMPTRESS

Actor Khushboo is no longer the only one being worshipped in Kollywood. **Namitha**, the southern siren who's more famous for her skin show than actual acting, is the second Tamil female actor to have a temple built in her honour. The voluptuous star originally belongs to Surat but burst on the big screen with Telugu film *Sontham* and soon moved on to Tamil cinema. Known for her off-screen antics and steamy scenes, we're waiting to see what the idol will adorn...a bikini or a sari?



## Breaking Barriers

An outsider making a debut in Bollywood is a welcome change—especially when it's someone who has moved to Mumbai from the US. After three years in the city, Gayatri Patel is living her 70 mm dream. The actress, who studied theatre at Emory University and has featured in ads and music videos, plays the lead in editor Aarif Patel's directorial debut *Let's Dance*. "I run a dance school in the film and dream of making it big as a performer," says Patel. The stage looks set for this one.



## SECOND TIME LUCKY

Let's just forget Sakshi Gulati acted in the little-watched *Delhi Heights*. The good thing is she will be seen in Ram Gopal Varma's forthcoming film *Contract*. The economics graduate, who also participated in the Miss India 2007 pageant, is playing "an emotionally dry character but as the story progresses you realise why she is so". The 25-year-old, who can't stop talking about Varma, says, "I'd love to do as many films as he's ready to take me in." Will she be an Urmila Matondkar or a Nisha Kothari? The bets are on.



## Burning Bright

Meena Barot, 36, has done what no Indian has before—carried the Olympic torch on Chinese soil. A business manager with a pharma company, Barot moved to China in 2005. She was chosen from seven expatriates, via an online poll she had entered in 2007. "I came to know about the competition from *China Daily*. I didn't want to enter initially," says Barot, who soon realised there wasn't any Indian in the top 20 list. "That's when I took part. I wanted an Indian to be the torchbearer." With 9,266 votes, she's got it.



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